

When looking for places to check your aptitude, try avoiding online tests and surveys. Most of these are scams, or unreliable, at best. There are several companies out there, however, who do a great job at assessing your inherent potential. They have a full-time in house team of professionals, including several psychiatrists to read into your test results and come up with valid projections about your potential skill set or aptitude towards a desired skill set.

Step Three: Research

Step number three comes into play when you're learning a new skill for a career path. This is when you put your years of training hounding Google to good use. Start researching and taking a good look at what kind of skills are needed for what kind of jobs. In this day and age, almost any kind of skill set is needed somewhere or the other. It is, however, important to hone said skills in a disciplined learning environment. Which is where the personal research comes in. Look around for sources to expand your skills and dust the cobwebs off your inhibitions. Remember to cross-examine what you find with the results of your aptitude test, just to see what lies in front of you. If you're having a hard time figuring out where to start, read this Fast Track cover-to-cover for good starting pointers on where you should let your learning begin.

Dismiss nothing

A lot of skills are sometimes taken for granted. What people don't realize is that today multi-skilled personnel are in huge demand. No one wants to pay five employees when one can do all their jobs without breaking a sweat. Why hire a team of PR personnel when that one guy can handle all your clients seamlessly? Why hire a copy editor when your writers can proofread each other's work? Why do you need a Director and a Writer on a movie when the writer can handle the director's job too?

The current job profile being sought after in every field is the proverbial Jack of all trades. But even if you manage to perfect two or three good malleable roles at the workplace (without burning yourself out), you're that much closer to being inexpendable.

So even things like being good at yoga (yoga instructor) or gaming (game tester/designer/bug reporter) can lead to several career options in your near future. Don't dismiss any kind of skill you may have, however mundane or frivolous it may seem. The chances are - if you've got it, someone wants it. And the deeper your pocket of honed skills is, the more people need you.